



The Underground Railroad

Small groups of enslaved people were secretly conducted north along the Underground Railroad, stopping at safe houses or "stations" on the indirect route. Fugitives evaded capture with the assistance of anti-slavery sympathizers.

Union adviser

After the Emancipation Proclamation, she redoubled her efforts on behalf of the Union cause in the South Carolina coastal areas, leading a group of Union scouts through the area's complex system of waterways, islands, and marshes. These forays gave Union commanders priceless local knowledge, and Secretary of War, Edwin Stanton, officially supported her efforts. In July 1863, using information gleaned on her scouting trips, Tubman advised and assisted Colonel James Montgomery in his raid of the Combahee River plantations by guiding Union steamboats past Confederate torpedoes to safe landing zones. Once ashore, the Union troops burned plantations and bridges, confiscated supplies, and liberated more than 700 enslaved people. Confederate soldiers arrived too late to stop the destruction, and the escaped slaves crowded onto the Federal steamboats. Many of them later joined the Black regiments that were forming.